

Next, be ready to get your toolbox out as the basics of VR technology are explored and followed up by our tutorial on building your very own VR headset – be it smartphone based or microcontroller powered. Wait! Don't skip to the third chapter yet, as we also find out the problems that Virtual Reality has faced on its road to popularity in the fourth chapter. Some of them still lie unsolved, which any VR developer has to be aware of. VR is headed towards a level of completion where even those problems are eradicated.

Augmented Reality is also a way in which we are trying to change the way we perceive our reality. It is more of an enhancement than a replacement compared to Virtual Reality. We explore their similarities and difference, while comparing the benefits of one over the other through the platforms where they can be experienced and their efficiency in their diverse range of applications.

If all of this has interested you to dive deeper into the whole VR phenomenon, Chapter 7 contains the guidelines that you need to follow when venturing into VR development, both in terms of hardware and software. We also explore the best alternatives available to a VR developer in today's VR ecosystem. The vastness of the venture might discourage you a bit, but the VR startups from around the world will surely inspire you.

Twenty years ago, people might have laughed at the idea of pocket phones that could have a virtual assistant that could automatically give you traffic updates, order your food, remind you of your meetings, etc. Yet that is almost taken for granted from any smartphone vendor nowadays. Similarly, outlandish concepts like an entirely virtual social network that lets you experience memories, surrogate bodies that go out into the real world instead of you and even mind uploading into a virtual reality might turn out to be true sooner than we can imagine. We close the Fasttrack with an ethical question about how much of this actually should be done, keeping in mind what being a human being stands for. 